

February 17, 2026

Senator Matthea E.L. Daughtry
President, Maine Senate
3 State House Station
Augusta, Maine 04333

Senator Teresa Pierce
Majority Leader, Maine Senate
3 State House Station
Augusta, Maine 04333

Senator Harold Stewart, III
Minority Leader, Maine Senate
3 State House Station
Augusta, Maine 04333

Senator Anne Carney
Chair, Maine Judiciary Committee
3 State House Station
Augusta, Maine 04333

RE: Letter in Opposition to Maine LB 1822

Dear Senate President Daughtry, Majority Leader Pierce, Minority Leader Stewart, and Chair Carney:

On behalf of the advertising industry, we write to oppose Maine LD 1822.¹ We provide this letter to offer our non-exhaustive list of concerns about this bill. Our organizations support meaningful privacy protections for Maine residents. As described in more detail below, LD 1822 contains provisions that would make Maine’s privacy law significantly out-of-step with privacy laws in other states, thereby adding to the increasingly complex privacy landscape for both businesses and consumers across the country. Accordingly, we ask you to decline to advance the bill as drafted out of the Maine Senate (“Senate”).

As the nation’s leading advertising and marketing trade associations, we collectively represent thousands of companies across the country. These companies range from small businesses to household brands, advertising agencies, and technology providers. Our combined membership includes more than 2,000 companies that power the commercial Internet, which accounted for nearly 20 percent of total U.S. gross domestic product (“GDP”) in 2024.² By one estimate, approximately 18.7% of Maine jobs in 2024 were related to the ad-subsidized Internet, a share projected to increase to 20.5% by 2029.³ Our group has more than a decade’s worth of hands-on experience it can bring to bear on matters related to consumer privacy and controls. We would welcome the opportunity to engage with the Senate further on the points we discuss in this letter.

I. Harmonization Across State Privacy Laws Fosters Consistency and Clarity for Consumers and Businesses

If enacted, LD 1822 would make the state’s approach to privacy an outlier in ways that would harm consumers and businesses of all sizes. Maine should instead focus its efforts on

¹ Maine LD 1822 (2026 Session), located [here](#) (hereinafter, “LD 1822”), as amended [here](#).

² S&P Global, THE ECONOMIC IMPACT OF ADVERTISING ON THE US ECONOMY, 2024-2029 at 4 (Aug. 2025), located at https://theadcoalition.com/wp-content/uploads/2025/08/TAC_SP-Global-Final-Report_August-2025.pdf.

³ *Id.* at 15-16.

harmonizing the bill with the approach to privacy in other states. A patchwork of differing privacy standards across the states would create significant costs for businesses and consumers alike. Efforts to harmonize state privacy legislation with existing privacy laws are critical to minimizing costs of compliance and fostering similar privacy rights for consumers no matter where they live. Below we provide a non-exhaustive list of ways LD 1822 would deviate from the dominant approach to privacy across states:

- LD 1822 would include an overly restrictive limitation on personal data collection that would stifle the economy and impede the availability of data to advertise products and services and combat fraud.
- LD 1822 would define “sensitive data” to include data elements no other state deems sensitive, would permit sensitive data processing only if “strictly necessary,” and would flatly ban sales of such data, which would harm consumers’ access to beneficial products and services.
- LD 1822 includes no concept of “pseudonymous data,” a privacy-protective data form that cannot be attributed to a specific individual without the use of additional information that is maintained separately and is subject to technical and organizational measures to ensure the data is not attributed to a specific individual. Pseudonymous data is defined and specifically exempted from all consumer privacy rights, except for the right to opt out, in most other state privacy laws.
- LD 1822 would require controllers to provide the names of their third-party business partners in responses to access requests, creating an onerous compliance requirement and competition concerns for controllers.
- LD 1822 would exempt any information made available for “sale” from the definition of “publicly available information,” deviating substantially from the definition of publicly available information in other states and restricting otherwise lawful transfers of public data.
- LD 1822 would impose burdensome notice requirements on third parties that would not realistically account for ways in which these entities receive and process personal data.
- LD 1822 would require a third party that assumes control of a business’s assets in the context of a merger, acquisition, bankruptcy, or similar transaction to provide “affected consumers” with notice of the transfer, an opportunity to withdraw any previously provided consent related to personal data processing, and an opportunity to request personal data deletion. This provision would create significant uncertainty and operational burden during mergers, acquisitions, and bankruptcies, materially diminish asset value, disrupt continuity of service, and discourage investment, ultimately harming both businesses and the consumers who rely on stable transitions.
- LD 1822 would include an untested “should know” knowledge standard for determining minors’ ages, creating confusion and adopting an approach to “knowledge” taken in no other state or federal privacy law.

Compliance costs associated with divergent privacy laws are significant. To make the point: a regulatory impact assessment of the California Consumer Privacy Act of 2018 concluded

that the initial compliance costs to California firms would be \$55 billion.⁴ Another recent study found that a consumer data privacy proposal in a different state considering privacy legislation would have generated a direct initial compliance cost of \$6.2 billion to \$21 billion and ongoing annual compliance costs of \$4.6 billion to \$12.7 billion for the state.⁵ Other studies confirm the staggering costs associated with varying state privacy standards. One report found that state privacy laws could impose out-of-state costs of between \$98 billion and \$112 billion annually, with costs exceeding \$1 trillion dollars over a 10-year period, and with small businesses shouldering a significant portion of the compliance cost burden.⁶ Harmonization with existing privacy laws is essential to create an environment where consumers in Maine have privacy protections that are consistent with those in other states, while minimizing unnecessary compliance costs for businesses. Maine should not add to this compliance bill for businesses and should instead opt for an approach to data privacy that is in harmony with already existing state privacy laws.

II. Overly Restrictive Limitations on Data Collection Would Stifle the Economy

LD 1822 previously included a data minimization term that would permit collection of personal data only if reasonably necessary and proportionate “to provide or maintain a product or service specifically requested by the consumer to whom the data pertains.”⁷ The amended version has updated this term to include an additional clarification after “pertains,” by adding the following language: “including any routine administrative, operational, website or account-servicing activity that is consistent with the reasonable expectations of the consumer under the circumstances. This paragraph does not prevent a controller from processing personal data collected in accordance with this paragraph to provide advertising to a consumer based on the consumer’s activities within the controller’s own websites or online applications.” Even with this amendment, the proposed data minimization term would impose significant limitations on the availability of personal data for targeted advertising to consumers and combatting fraud.

For example, even with this amendment, the proposed data minimization term may be interpreted to constrain targeted advertising, particularly with respect to prospecting for new customers. Prospecting typically involves collecting and analyzing personal data to identify individuals who have not yet engaged with a business but who may be interested in its products or services. However, the data minimization term would limit personal data collection to what is reasonably necessary and proportionate to provide or maintain a product or service “specifically

⁴ See State of California Department of Justice Office of the Attorney General, *Standardized Regulatory Impact Assessment: California Consumer Privacy Act of 2018 Regulations*, 11 (Aug. 2019), located at https://dof.ca.gov/wp-content/uploads/sites/352/Forecasting/Economics/Documents/CCPA_Regulations-SRIA-DOF.pdf.

⁵ See Florida Tax Watch, *Who Knows What? An Independent Analysis of the Potential Effects of Consumer Data Privacy Legislation in Florida*, 2 (Oct. 2021), located at <https://floridatxwatch.org/DesktopModules/EasyDNNNews/DocumentDownload.ashx?portalid=210&moduleid=34407&articleid=19090&documentid=986>.

⁶ Daniel Castro, Luke Dascoli, and Gillian Diebold, *The Looming Cost of a Patchwork of State Privacy Laws* (Jan. 24, 2022), located at <https://itif.org/publications/2022/01/24/looming-cost-patchwork-state-privacy-laws> (finding that small businesses would bear approximately \$20-23 billion of the out-of-state cost burden associated with state privacy law compliance annually).

⁷ LD 1822 at § 9608(2)(A).

requested by the consumer.” That standard does not naturally encompass the collection of personal data about individuals who have not made a request or initiated a relationship with the business. As a result, prospecting activities, such as building audiences, enriching lead lists, or using personal data to identify potential new customers, could fall outside the permitted purposes for data collection. Although the amendment clarifies that advertising based on a consumer’s activities within a controller’s own websites or applications is allowed, that carveout is focused on existing customers and first-party interactions and does not clearly authorize data collection and use practices that underpin targeted advertising aimed at attracting new customers. Specifically, the proposed amendment would not address a business’s need to identify and attract consumers that have not yet interacted with the business. This is particularly problematic for new and small businesses that lack an online presence or operate mainly offline.

In addition, the proposed term would severely inhibit third-party companies who do not have direct relationships with consumers from collecting personal data to further vital consumer fraud prevention efforts. Fraud prevention services and service providers work in the background of online transactions, protecting consumers by verifying that consumers are who they say they are in real time. Consumers do not affirmatively request this service; it is part and parcel of their day-to-day online experience and their expectations for transacting safely online. As a result of the proposed data minimization term, third-party fraud prevention services may be forced to refrain from collecting and making data available that Maine businesses rely on to prevent fraud, thereby making Maine consumers more susceptible to identity theft and other negative outcomes.

The vast majority of states that have passed a data privacy law permit businesses to collect and process personal data as reasonably necessary and proportionate to achieve the purposes for which the personal data was collected, as disclosed to the consumer.⁸ LD 1822 would contradict this reasonable, majority approach, thereby subjecting Maine consumers to fewer benefits of data processing than their counterparts in nearby states and other parts of the country. Maine should take steps to align LD 1822’s data minimization terms with other states instead of adopting an onerous and untested approach to data collection and processing that could disadvantage Maine consumers and businesses.

III. LD 1822’s Restrictions on Sensitive Data Processing Would Hinder Delivery of Beneficial Services to Maine Consumers

LD 1822 would prohibit a controller from collecting, processing, or sharing sensitive data concerning a consumer, unless the collection or processing is “strictly necessary to provide or maintain a specific product or service requested by the consumer.”⁹ The bill would also flatly ban sales of sensitive data, without providing exceptions to this broad restriction for instances where consumers consent to sensitive data transfers or when such transfers are expected by consumers in the context of their relationship with controllers.¹⁰ Given the bill’s definition of

⁸ See, e.g., Cal. Civ. Code § 1798.100(c); Va. Code Ann. § 59.1-578(1).

⁹ LD 1822 at Sec. 9608(1)(A).

¹⁰ *Id.* at § 9608(1)(B).

sensitive data, which includes data elements that no other state considers sensitive,¹¹ the proposed limitation on sensitive data processing and sales would severely hinder the delivery of beneficial products and services to Maine consumers. Instead of advancing this broad proposal, the Senate should amend the bill to mirror approximately 20 other state privacy laws that have been enacted to date by requiring consumer consent to process sensitive data.

Sensitive data is processed and transferred (i.e., “sold”) to provide consumers with messaging about various products and services from which they derive significant benefits. Without the ability to “sell” and process sensitive data for advertising purposes subject to consumer consent, businesses will have a more difficult time, and face higher costs, reaching individuals with relevant marketing. For example, the provisions in LD 1822 could functionally prohibit religious organizations from reaching out to potential new parishioners and bespoke cultural product providers from reaching individuals of particular ethnicities with messaging and advertising about their products. The ability to use this data to advertise is also especially meaningful for Maine’s small and medium-sized businesses who provide products and services that may be particularly relevant to specific constituencies.

The bill’s ban on sensitive data sales and limits on processing would also have other downstream effects. For instance, precise geolocation data—a type of sensitive data under the bill—powers important emergency notices, particularly AMBER alerts and severe weather notices, allowing these notices to be immediately displayed to users in the impacted area on any device they are using.¹² Location information also enables effective fraud prevention to protect consumers and businesses. Financial institutions, retailers, and others rely on anti-fraud services that include location information provided by third parties. The “sale” and processing of location information allows anti-fraud and identity protection services to flag suspicious behavior and protect vulnerable communities. For example, companies can more easily detect credit card theft or fraud if they have access to location information showing that a consumer is not in the location where a purchase is being made. However, such processing may not be “strictly necessary” for providing a product or service requested by a consumer, and therefore, could be outlawed if LD 1822 becomes law. As a result, sensitive data such as precise geolocation data would be less likely to be collected in the marketplace, making it less available overall for important emergency alert, fraud prevention, and other beneficial uses. The Senate should update LD 1822 to remove the onerous limits on sensitive data processing and the ban on sensitive data sales. The Senate should replace these provisions with a requirement for controllers to obtain consumer consent to process sensitive data.

IV. LD 1822 Would Diverge from Existing Privacy Laws by Requiring Controllers to Disclose the Names of Specific Third-Party Partners

¹¹ *Id.* at § 9602(34).

¹² See, e.g., *Federation for Internet Alerts*, located [here](#) (describing a partnership between FIA and the National Center for Missing and Exploited Children (NCMEC) that leverages the same technology used to deliver advertising and marketing messages to issue and maximize the effectiveness of alerts for emergencies such as child abductions, tornado warnings, and other hazards).

Another way LD 1822 diverges from existing state privacy laws is that it would require controllers to disclose the names of their third-party partners in response to a consumer access request.¹³ The overwhelming majority of state privacy laws require companies to disclose the *categories* of third parties to whom they transfer personal data rather than the specific names of such third parties themselves in response to access requests.¹⁴ Requiring disclosure of the names of entities would provide little to no benefits to consumers, would not materially enhance consumers' understanding of controllers' data practices, and would be operationally burdensome, as controllers change business partners frequently, and companies regularly merge with others and change names. For instance, a controller may engage in a data exchange with a new business-customer on the same day it responds to a consumer request. This requirement would either force the controller to refrain from engaging in commerce with the new business-customer until its consumer access disclosures are updated, or risk violating the law. This is an unreasonable restraint. From an operational standpoint, constantly updating a list of all third-party partners a controller works with would take significant resources and time away from companies' efforts to comply with other new privacy directives in LD 1822.

Even international privacy standards like the European Union's General Data Protection Regulation do not require burdensome disclosures of specific third parties in response to data subject access requests, according to the text of the law. Mandating that companies disclose the names of their third-party partners could obligate companies to contravene confidentiality clauses they maintain in their contracts with partners and expose proprietary business information to their competitors. Finally, the consumer benefit that would accrue from their receipt of a list of third-party partners to whom a controller discloses data would be minimal at best where the cost clearly outweighs the benefit. For these reasons, we encourage you to reconsider this onerous requirement, which severely diverges from the approach to required disclosures taken in existing state privacy laws.

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¹³ *Id.* at § 9606(1)(F).

¹⁴ *See, e.g.*, Cal. Civ. Code § 1798.110; Va. Code Ann. § 59.1-578(C); Colo. Rev. Stat. § 6-1-1301(1)(a); Utah Rev. Stat § 16-61-302(1)(a).



We and our members strongly support meaningful privacy protections for consumers. We believe, however, that LD 1822 will not further meaningful consumer protections in Maine and instead will diverge significantly from other state privacy laws in ways that will hinder Maine consumers' access to digital resources and Maine businesses' ability to reach new customers. We therefore respectfully ask the Senate to decline to advance LD 1822 as proposed.

Thank you in advance for your consideration of this letter.

Sincerely,

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